

It's all about the data

Consider your average computer/smartphone application, one of the modules that are essential towards making the app interactive is the database. It's a structured manner of storing data on your phone, computer and the cloud. From its early days at IBM to its current form, the database has evolved over the years but the central aspect has remained more or less the same. The commands that you can use to make your program interact with the database have also remained unchanged over the years. It's been more than fifty years since the widespread use of databases began and their unchanging and pervasive nature simply means that they're going to be around for much longer and thus, learning databases is absolutely essential. Moreover, databases are quite simple to learn so this FastTrack should be a breeze.

A quick look at job market listings should make it clear that SQL skills are one of the most common requirements for anyone looking to get into the programming / app / web development sector. Aside from these, even the upcoming career options such as “data science” relies heavily on the data manipulation skills of the individual. A 2018 StackOverflow survey of individuals working as data scientists revealed that SQL was more frequently used than Python, R or any other programming language. For the uninitiated, Python and R are the most common programming languages used by data scientists. So, for database skills to be used more frequently than the programming languages and libraries, is saying something. Speaking of upcoming skills, that's a topic we explore in much greater detail in the main Digit Magazine so be sure to check that out.